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I. A Bigger Theory of Work

See new ways to lead and better ways to work.

II. Business Models

Learn to use a powerful tool for describing and analyzing organizational, team, and personal business models.

III. Teamwork

Boost teamwork with new tools that complement business model thinking.

IV. Application Guide

Discover how others did it, and how to make it work for yourself, your team, and your organization.

This brief preview includes the first two pages of each chapter, plus all of Chapter 7. The book will be released in June 2017.

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Business Models for Teams

See How Your Organization Really Works and How Each Person Fits In

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Originator of the Business Model Canvas
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Co-created by 225 profess

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This Book's Business Model

Altogether, 225 people from 39 nations contributed to the writing, editing, and production of Business Models for Teams. Draft chapters were uploaded to an online community, where they were reviewed, discussed, and critiqued over a period of 15 months. We estimate that collectively, this group brought to the book more than 5,000 years of full-time professional experience in business, technology, government, academics, medicine, law, design, and other disciplines. The names of all 225 contributors appear on the following two pages.

We are grateful to our contributors, who confirmed our long-standing faith in distributed intelligence—and in a truly global perspective urgently needed in organizations of all kinds here in the United States. Our contributors live in Australia, Austria, Belgium, Brazil, Canada, Chile, China, Colombia, Cypress, Denmark, Finland, France, Germany, Hungary, India, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Japan, Jordan, Luxembourg, Malaysia, Mexico, the Netherlands, New Zealand, the Philippines, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Singapore, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, the United Kingdom, the United Arab Emirates, the United States, and Vietnam.

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If the spirit moves you, join us at BusinessModelsForTeams.com to receive any of the tools featured in this book free of charge. You will discover an online community of more than 12,000 business model enthusiasts from 80 countries, including the 225 contributors listed on the following pages.

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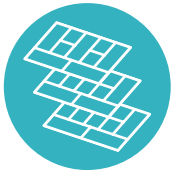

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Chapter 1

From *Me* to *We*

The Player-Coach

"I noticed you don't have enough players. Can I join your team?"

He looked hopeful. And in his international soccer jersey, he also looked knowledgeable, something the rest of us could not claim. Our motley team of graduate students took to the field each week to compete in California's San Jose Industrial Soccer League, originally so we could enjoy the excellent post-game parties. We were tied for last place.

"Why not?" our captain replied. "We need all the help we can get."

"That you do!" the visitor said. Everyone laughed.

The visitor introduced himself as Ramy. He had been a player-coach in Egypt for years before coming to the United States for graduate school. His appearance was timely: we had recently tired of playing poorly, of spending time and energy on soccer without showing much improvement. Ramy joined us and agreed to serve as player-coach.

Things changed. Ramy started bringing out the best in everyone by teaching what he called "a bigger theory of the game." And over time, we slowly transformed into a real team. The differences between our old and new styles of play were dramatic:

- Most of us were simply *chasing the ball*. Ramy taught us to see and relate *to each other.*
- Ramy taught us to strive to be the best *playmakers* rather than the best *players*.
- We had focused excessively on playing *positions*. Ramy taught us to *see what was happening on the entire field.*
- We had been playing mainly to socialize. Ramy gave us a bigger purpose: *improving our skills and becoming a winning team.*

One season after our new player-coach joined us, we placed second in our league. Spouses and friends turned into enthusiastic supporters. And we still loved the post-game parties, especially because we could now celebrate our wins.[1]

From *Me* to *We*

Ramy helped transform a group of amateur U.S. soccer players into a true team. How? By appealing to four things that motivate people:

Purpose
People want to be part of something greater than themselves. Ramy brought a greater purpose: becoming a winning team.

Autonomy
People want to direct their own lives. Ramy showed teammates how to make things happen.

Relatedness
People want to feel connected. Ramy taught his teammates to work together and make plays.

Mastery
People want to get better and better at something. Ramy showed his teammates how to build their skills.[2]

Though Ramy was teaching soccer, he might just as well have been tackling a challenge faced by many organizations: coaching people to stop focusing on *me* and start focusing on *we*. In short, building better teams.

Every leader wants better teamwork. Yet all teams are, to some extent, conflicted and dysfunctional. Teamwork consultant Patrick Lencioni says this happens for the simple reason that teams "are made up of imperfect human beings" facing a constant, internal tug-of-war.[3]

At work, people struggle to balance personal needs (*What's in it for me?*) with team aims (*What's best for the group?*). Personal career decisions, too, often seem like tough choices between survival and seeking meaningful work. This tension between *me* and *we* is biological, permanent, and irresolvable, says Pulitzer Prize-winning Harvard biologist Edward O. Wilson:

> *Are we built to pledge our lives to a group? Or to place ourselves and our families above all else? Scientific evidence . . . suggests that we are both of these things simultaneously . . . The products of the two opposing vectors . . . are hardwired in our emotions and reasoning, and cannot be erased.*[4]

No wonder leading a team is so challenging; it demands tirelessly moving back and forth between personal needs and group goals.

Leaders must somehow address both the self-serving *me* and the group-serving *we*. But the *me-we* conflict is inevitable, so eliminating it is impossible. Instead, a good team-builder uses this tension to everyone's benefit. The goal is to shift people toward *we* behavior by artfully recognizing everyone's *me*. *Business Models for Teams* will show you how—and like Ramy, make you a standout player-coach for *your* organization.

Chapter 2

Modeling Organizations

Tweak in Logic Sparks Revolution

The Haloid Photographic Company, founded in Rochester, New York more than a century ago, is a largely forgotten firm. But at a pivotal moment in Haloid's history, a simple business model tweak utterly transformed the company into a global technology powerhouse, sparking an information-sharing revolution and creating an iconic brand still recognized everywhere today.

In 1958, Haloid had invented a plain-paper photocopier it believed could revolutionize how information was shared in large and medium-sized enterprises that relied on carbon paper or special coated-paper machines for making copies. But Haloid's device, dubbed the Model 914, was expensive and as big as a deep freezer, weighing 648 pounds (nearly 300 kilograms). IBM, one of Haloid's potential manufacturing partners for the 914, hired the distinguished consultancy Arthur D. Little to investigate the device's market potential. In their conclusion, the consultants wrote, "Model 914 has no future in the office copying market."[1]

A second study conducted by consultancy Ernst & Ernst produced only slightly less pessimistic findings. But Haloid persisted, confident its machine could unlock tremendous value for far-sighted customers.

Soon afterward, it occurred to product planning chief John Glavin that Haloid could change how the company offered the machine. Instead of asking customers to purchase the expensive device outright, why not offer a low-cost lease, put a meter on the machine, and charge users a per-copy fee? This would dramatically lower the initial cash investment and give customers a chance to assess the machine's usefulness. Haloid management decided to try this approach.

Aside from the switch to metered leasing, nothing else changed: the device remained exactly the same, as did Haloid's customers. Yet this simple tweak in benefit delivery logic revolutionized the industry. Within a dozen years, Haloid's sales skyrocketed from U.S. $30 million to U.S. $1.2 billion.[2] Along the way, the company adopted a new name: Xerox.

The new photocopier created tremendous benefits for enterprises: it enabled them to replicate and share important information quickly and at low cost (remember, this was before the invention of personal computers and the Internet).

Customers embraced the amazing device and made billions of copies, matched by billions of dollars in sales. The new business model, whereby Xerox leased photocopier hardware at low cost and charged customers for actual copies made each month, worked brilliantly for decades.

A Fading Model

But trouble loomed. Japanese makers released smaller, highly-competitive copiers. In the early 1990s, commercial Internet access services became available, and in 1993, Adobe Systems made its PDF file specifications publicly available free of charge. Slowly, digital files and the Internet began to replace paper as the preferred way to replicate and share information. Xerox's traditional copier-leasing business model began to show its age.

Meanwhile, Xerox aggressively embraced the digital revolution, inventing or developing transformational technologies such as the personal computer, the laser printer, the computer mouse, the graphical user interface, and Ethernet.[3] Yet it was unable to commercialize these important technologies. Instead, they were exploited by other companies—notably Apple Computer—that used business models very different from Xerox's copier-leasing logic.

In years following, Xerox was buffeted by waves of technical, social, and economic change. The paperless office, the "green" revolution, and cost-cutting demanded by harder economic times steadily undermined its mainstay photocopier business model.[4] Though Xerox remains an international technology powerhouse, as of this writing its market capitalization is less than one-fiftieth that of Apple Computer, a key beneficiary of Xerox innovations.[5]

Xerox's extraordinary history teaches two lessons. First, it is possible for an enterprise to literally transform itself by altering its business model. Second, even brilliant business models eventually expire. In industry after industry, business model lifespans are shrinking as technological, economic, and social change accelerates—and competition intensifies.

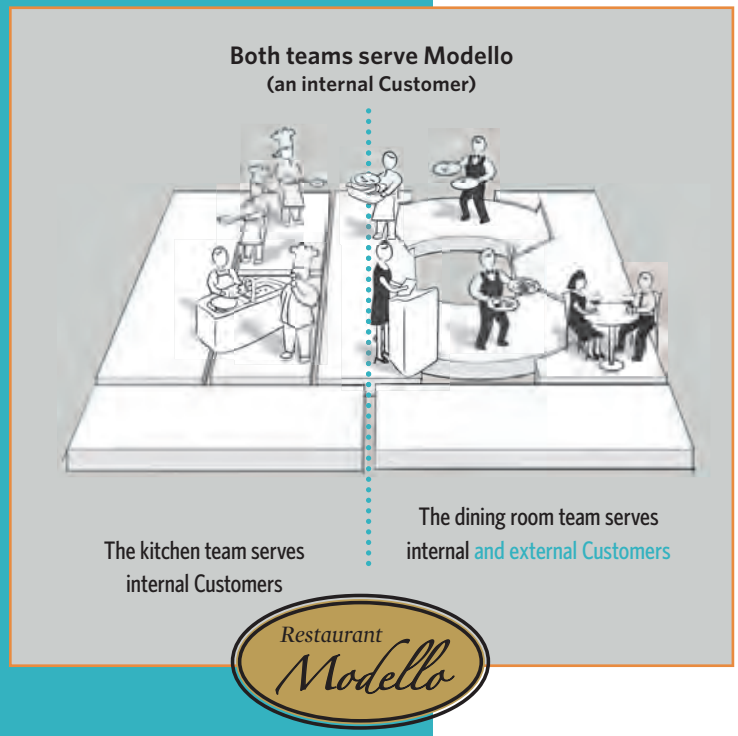
Amid this turbulence, business modeling skills are essential for leaders and aspiring leaders alike. Enter the Business Model Canvas: an extraordinarily useful tool that depicts the logic by which enterprises create and deliver value to customers, and are compensated for doing so.

Chapter 3

Modeling Teams

Whom Do I Help?

Every enterprise has a business model, and the Business Model Canvas shows at a glance how that enterprise works. Similarly, most enterprises consist of teams, and the Business Model Canvas can show at a glance how each team within the enterprise works. This chapter explains how to diagram team business models. Start by answering two crucial questions all workers must ask themselves. The first question is, *Whom do I help*? In other words, *Who is my Customer?*



Who is my Customer?
Think of your own work situation. Your main Customer is *whoever makes the decision to purchase your services.* If you are an employee of the Modello restaurant, for example, Steve Brown is your main Customer, because he decided to purchase your services by hiring you. Steve is an internal Customer, because you and he work for the same organization.

Now, who are Steve's main Customers? Steve's main Customers are Modello *diners*, because they decide to purchase meals at his restaurant. Diners are external Customers, because they do not work for the same organization as Steve.

Whom do I help? is a crucial question, *because few people gain true satisfaction by helping only themselves*. Deep down, people yearn to help others through their work. Helping others activates one of the four key human motivators: Purpose.

Purpose is easiest to spot with external Customers. At Modello, for example, waiters and hostesses experience firsthand helping diners enjoy a special night out, or facilitating group bonding at a gracefully catered dinner. But people who serve internal Customers, like cooks and dishwashers, can have a harder time seeing how their work helps others.

How Do I Help?

A dishwasher, for example, understands that he helps the restaurant. But to him, the restaurant may be an impersonal entity. When the dishwasher understands *whom* he helps—the cooks and servers he sees every day at work—the *whom* becomes personal. That is why it is so important that each worker understands how their work benefits specific team members, not just the enterprise.

The second crucial question all workers must ask themselves is, *How do I help?* When a dishwasher understands how cooks and servers depend on clean cookware and dishes to do their own jobs, he understands teamwork's core: *interdependency*. By helping his teammates, he gains a greater sense of purpose and job satisfaction. Over time, he begins to see how his activities contribute to the success of the restaurant.

The teamwork table here describes each kitchen team member's role, tasks, Customers served, results of task success, and consequences of task failure.

Kitchen Team Teamwork Table

*Ripple-through effect from external Customers

Role	Tasks	Internal Customers	Result of task success	Consequence of task failure
Chef	Design, update excellent menu	Modello (Steve)	Good reputation, financial success	Reputational/financial loss
	Train and supervise	Cooks	Better professional skills, bigger tips*	Smaller tips, poor social media reviews*
	Explain menu, train servers to recommend dishes, prevent allergic reactions	Servers	Repeat external Customers, bigger tips*	Lost external Customers, smaller tips, poor social media reviews*
Cooks	Correctly and consistently prepare menu items	Modello (Steve)	Good reputation, financial success	Reputational/financial loss
	Correctly and consistently prepare menu items	Servers	Repeat external Customers, bigger tips*	Lost external Customers, smaller tips, poor social media reviews*
Dishwasher	Promptly and thoroughly wash dinnerware, cookware	Modello (Steve)	Positive image	Poor image
	Promptly and thoroughly wash cookware	Cooks	Work proceeds smoothly	Delayed work, frustration
	Promptly and thoroughly wash dinnerware	Servers	Eliminate cleanliness-related complaints, bigger tips*	Unpredictable dining experience, loss of Customers, smaller tips, unfavorable social media postings*

One of a leader's most important tasks is to help others see why their work matters to someone.[1] People who grasp teamwork—who they help and how they help—have built a foundation for self-organization and self-direction. Next, learn how to use the Canvas to draw a team business model.

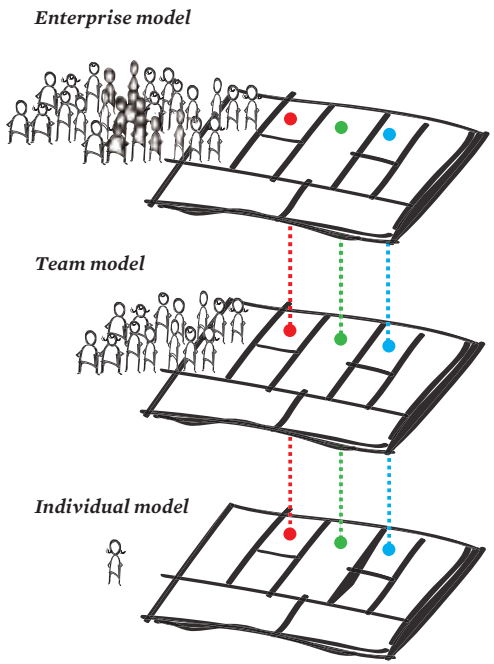
Chapter 4

Modeling People

Enterprises, Teams, and Individuals

By now you have seen how useful it is to view teams as having business models that complement enterprise models. Similarly, every individual has a *personal* business model that shows how they contribute to a team.

A personal model helps reframe an individual's reason for coming to work every day as a Value Proposition. When every person's personal model is in sync with team goals, you will lead an unbeatable group. On the other hand, when people are out of sync with their team, adjustments will be needed. As a leader who moves back and forth between personal needs and group goals, your job is to find misalignments and take action.



The purpose of this chapter is 1) to teach you how to use the Personal Business Model Canvas to draw and use personal business models, and 2) to show ways to identify misalignments between individuals and teams. The Personal Business Model Canvas uses the same enterprise business model vocabulary to frame individual work in terms of departmental and organizational goals. At the same time, it allows people to express their individuality and pursue personal ambitions in the most appropriate organizational role.

Personal Business Models

First, note some differences between group and personal models:

- In a personal business model, the Key Resource is *you*: your interests, skills and abilities, personality, and values. Compared to an enterprise or team, an individual is "resource-constrained"—another reason to recognize how much we depend on others to succeed.

- Unlike teams or enterprises that may deliver products to external Customers through their models, it is helpful to think of individuals as providing their labor as a *service*. That service is most often provided to internal Customers.

- A personal business model takes into account unquantifiable "soft" costs (such as stress) and "soft" rewards (such as professional growth). Most enterprise models consider only monetary costs and benefits.

Be sure to practice drawing your own personal business model before using personal business models with colleagues.[1]

Chapter 5

Begin With *Me*

Begin With *Me*

For leaders, few things are more rewarding than seeing someone thrive thanks to your guidance and encouragement. And few things are more difficult than disciplining, reassigning, or terminating workers. No single leadership strategy can both ease the difficulties and assure the rewards. But most leaders agree that—were it possible—the ability to directly touch what motivates people would be extraordinarily valuable.

Intrinsic Motivator	Definition
Purpose	The yearning to do what we do in the service of something larger than ourselves
Autonomy	The desire to direct our own lives
Relatedness	The urge to be recognized by and connected to others
Mastery	The drive to improve our skill at doing something that matters

What motivates people in the workplace is now a matter of scientific fact. Research conducted over decades has identified four intrinsic human motivators: ***Purpose, Autonomy, Relatedness,*** and ***Mastery***.[1] Each of these four motivators is described in the table at left. See if you agree that they hold true for you, too.

The question for leaders, then, is not what motivates people—it is how to tap into the four motivators. What comes closest to putting your hands directly on the levers of behavior?

The answer is simple. But understanding it requires some background logic.

First, it is clear that leaders must somehow link team or enterprise goals to intrinsic motivators at the individual level. As people develop, at no point will you see them express an inherent desire to increase fourth quarter earnings or introduce the next software upgrade by next summer or double the number of successful adoptions at a social service agency. Such goals are organizational milestones that motivate leaders of traditional organizations. But what motivates individuals is ***Purpose, Autonomy, Relatedness,*** and ***Mastery***.

That means the most common approach to motivation—mechanically promoting alignment with team or organizational goals without addressing very human motivations—will end up disappointing both parties. Leaders need a way to simultaneously address all four human motivators. Consider each of the four and how it relates to work:

Purpose: Work means helping other people. Individuals can understand who their organization helps by learning the enterprise business model. They can also find purpose in helping others do their jobs better.

Autonomy: People can learn to manage their own work lives, especially with guidance from a good leader. "Autonomy" is used here in the psychological sense of *agency* or *self-efficacy*, not independence from a group. Few people like being told what to do; most enjoy being part of a team.

Relatedness: For many people, the workplace provides a strong sense of belonging and social interaction. And recognition by a formal authority figure is a powerful motivator for almost everyone.

Mastery: The workplace is where most people build skills and experience. Leaders who facilitate this earn loyalty and respect.

These four motivators are also provided by family, friends, hobbies, sports, faith, and other pursuits. But for most people, the workplace—and work itself—is the key source of the four motivators. And for most people, various forms of work gel over time into what is called *career.* Career is a single concern that directly touches all four intrinsic motivators—the levers that trigger behavior. And the current state of anyone's career can be concisely expressed in the form of a single-sheet Personal Business Model. If you are wondering how to motivate people, knock on the door marked **career**.

Chapter 6

Align *Me* With *We*

So far you have learned to use business models to depict organizations, teams, and individuals. Now it is time to work on aligning models to reduce the guesswork and conflict that people experience as they strive to work effectively in organizations. The most basic alignment is between organizational and individual models. Consider the experience of one growing U.S. company that essentially reinvented itself by aligning me with we.

Abandoning *What*, Starting Over With *Why*

Fitness center franchise Fit For Life had always promoted *what* it offered: beautiful facilities and fantastic equipment—things few members could afford to own themselves. But the U.S. recession that began in 2008 nearly killed the business: customers quit in droves after deciding that gym membership was, after all, a luxury. The owner brought in a new partner to turn things around.

The franchise's new CEO, Perry Lunsford, recognized that remaining members were those committed to long-term training programs—they did not consider gym memberships discretionary. Based on that insight, Perry, a fan of Simon Sinek's Golden Circle,[1] decided to reverse the traditional gym strategy. Instead of focusing on Fit For Life's *what*—facility and equipment—he would promote Fit for Life's *why:* fitness and good health. Perry and his team defined their *why* as "to change people's lives."

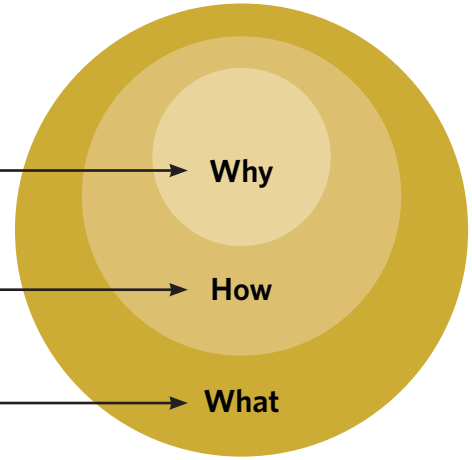
The revamped company achieved good results by presenting life-changing personal fitness, rather than facility access, as the key membership benefit. Yet Fit For Life still faced a stiff challenge. It had successfully redesigned its strategy, but now it needed employees to commit to the new *why:* to align each individual *me* with the collective *we.*

Fit for Life's Application of The Golden Circle

We believe all lives can be changed for the better and find purpose in our own lives making that happen

The way we change lives for the better is through purposeful exercise programs

We sell affordable, effective fitness programs in beautiful, friendly facilities



Matching Personality and Activities, Sharing the *Why*

One big problem was that personal trainers served as the company's de facto training salesforce. Yet trainers are often weak salespeople, says Fit For Life CFO Bob Fariss. Bob used personal business models to analyze different roles within the company and gain insight into how the typical trainer's *skyle* was a poor match for selling.

"Your typical trainer is a wonderful, caring human being who really wants to help others and is therefore a bit uncomfortable asking for money," Bob says. "They often do not do well at closing sales, and because of that, many do not make enough money to survive in the job."

Hire People Who Believe What You Believe

Management realized it could no longer rely only on trainers to sell training. Instead, it needed to hire new people to sell both memberships and personal training services. At the same time, it needed to make sure all employees understood the new why—and were personally committed to changing people's lives. So Perry and his team crafted a new help-wanted advertisement—one that extended the company why to the personal level. Here is how Fit For Life's new ad read:

We do a lot of things really awesome. One of those things is sell personal training better than anyone else in the fitness industry. I was tired of watching great trainers go back to school to be firemen and nurses, because they couldn't feed their families when gyms didn't know how to feed them. Fit For Life has been in business since 1991 and over the years we have developed a sales process that changes people's lives. We change the lives of our franchisees, we change the lives of our members and most importantly for this post, we change the lives of our trainers! We give them the opportunity to make real money and to have a real career doing the thing they really love!

Chapter 7

Align *We* to *We*

The following case illustrates how tools described in previous chapters were used to solve tough workplace problems.[1] Note how business models were used, not to reconfigure strategy, but to 1) clarify what teams do and why, and 2) ensure that the work itself, rather than personality or politics, guided people's behavior.

The Mentor

"Here's my new card, Lianne. Happy to help out anytime. Glad I'm staying on as an internal consultant for a while. Not sure what I'd do as a retiree." The older man laughed as he sipped his espresso.

Lianne Amsden took the card. It read:

Spartan Specialty Fabrications

Boris Latchaw
Internal Consultant

"Well, thanks again, Boris. I wish you were still my boss. See you on Monday!" Lianne slipped the card into her bag, replaced her cup, paid the bill, and walked to her car. As she pulled out of the coffee shop parking lot, she suddenly spun the wheel right instead of left. *Given the earnings I bring in, Spartan can afford to let me go home an hour early*, she thought. During the 20-minute drive home, she pondered Boris's advice—and her own future with her employer: Spartan Specialty Fabrications.

Spartan Specialty Fabrications was a century-old "metal-banger" company, as Boris and the old-timers liked to say. The firm built massive, customized iron and steel structures: marine bulkheads, bridge spans, 20-meter high containment vessels for nuclear power plants, meter-thick missile silo doors, and other components demanding unique combinations of precision, quality, and size. Lianne was a rarity in this world: a woman engineer who could talk shop with welders in the morning and present to Nuclear Regulatory Agency inspectors in the afternoon.

Early in her career as a mechanical engineer with the Port Authority, Lianne had become fascinated with massive bridge and bulwark components. Several years later she joined Spartan, one of the vendors she had overseen as a Port Authority inspector. She first worked in Spartan's shipbuilding division, then in commercial fabrication, then with a new team devoted to making components for the regulation-heavy nuclear power industry. That is when Boris Latchaw became her boss. Boris became Lianne's mentor and a welcome advocate for her progress within Spartan's testosterone-fueled culture—until health concerns forced him to consider retiring. Fortunately, Spartan's CEO had persuaded Boris to stay on for another year as a roving internal consultant.

That is when Lianne took over leadership of the nuclear division. And that is when the trouble started.

The Reorganization

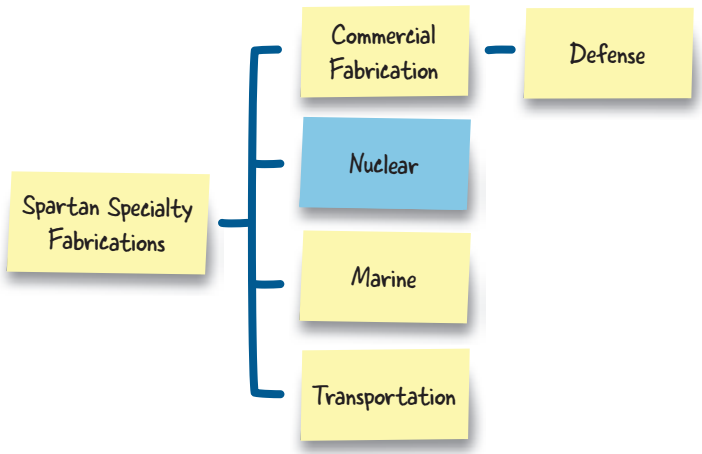
Boris had started Spartan's nuclear business as a small, specialized "product team" reporting directly to the CEO. After Boris hired Lianne, sales jumped, thanks in large part to Lianne's extensive regulatory expertise. So when health problems forced Boris to take a six-month leave of absence, he pushed for Lianne to take over the nuclear team—and become Spartan's first woman manager.

Other Spartan executives argued—correctly—that Lianne lacked leadership experience beyond project management. These executives included general manager Damian Glynn, who also led Spartan's Commercial Fabrication business unit. Commercial Fabrication served infrastructure builders by constructing everything from bridge components to oil rigs.

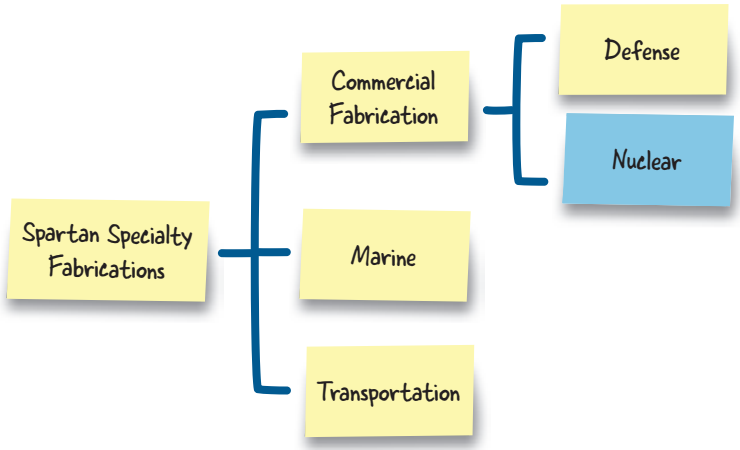
In the end, Lianne was promoted to manager of the nuclear team. But in a nod to those who felt she needed more leadership experience, her nuclear team was made into a sub-team reporting to Damian's Commercial Fabrication division.

The logic was twofold: 1) Damian would provide extensive fabrication leadership experience, and 2) Nuclear was similar to the Defense group—another team with a highly uniform Customer base—which also reported to Commercial Fabrication. The reorganization made sense on paper. But in practice, it was a mess.

Nuclear started as a standalone product team . . .



. . . then was repositioned as a Commercial Fabrication sub-team



Heavy Metal Meets New Wave

Lianne had vivid memories of poorly executed performance reviews from her previous managers—when they bothered to conduct reviews at all. Boris had been the single exception.

Now a manager herself, Lianne was determined to do better. She had stayed late for weeks (and even a Saturday or two) to make sure all her direct reports had one-on-one meetings and comprehensive performance evaluations completed by the February deadline. At the last management meeting, she quietly but proudly announced completion of this important work: right after Damian, the meeting chair, reported that none of his own reviews were complete.

Damian reacted to Lianne's accomplishment with all-too-familiar dismissive humor. "Well, I guess some people don't have enough *real* work to do!" he said, drawing a few chuckles from other attendees. Lianne unthinkingly slammed her hand to the conference table and gritted her teeth. But she managed to keep herself from making a caustic reply.

"That cowboy Damian drives me nuts," she later complained to Boris. "If he puts those snakeskin boots up on a table one more time, I'm going to . . ."

Boris interrupted. "Steady, partner! Plain talk with your own staff worked. Couldn't you use that same spirit to 'manage up' and speak one-on-one with Damian?"

"I tried," Lianne replied. "He said I don't understand how Commercial Fabrication runs, or the way Spartan's business works outside of my 'unique little nuclear world.' I reminded him that our team generates better earnings than any other unit at Spartan. That killed the conversation."

Boris looked thoughtful for a moment. Then he spoke. "Lianne, I think it's time for you to *adapt your style*."

Three Questions for Lianne

"You've made some strong work accomplishments," Boris began. "But they're mostly about managing *down:* leading the people who report to you directly." The older man explained the Three Questions and asked Lianne to describe how each was relevant to her situation:

1. Time to Move Out? *No.* Lianne had considered quitting, but leaving Spartan did not feel right. She felt committed to her team and to the important work they were known for delivering.

2. Time to Move Up? *No.* Her latest role as the Nuclear team manager was a well-deserved promotion, and her former boss-turned-advisor believed she could handle it. But the dysfunctional relationship with Damian, her new manager, demanded that she address the third question.

3. Time to Adapt Style? *Yes.* Lianne had the skills, knowledge, and ability needed for success in her new leadership role. But her delivery style was falling short. "Now, it's time for you to *adapt your style* so you can build greater capacity for *managing up*," said Boris. "Your leadership challenge is less about producing results and more about aligning your team with other teams—and the enterprise."

Boris explained the five-stage career model and noted that Lianne began, as most leaders do, by testing her training. Then she developed a specialty and a good reputation based on strengths in fabrication processes, production planning, and regulatory affairs. But now she was in stage three: she had jumped to *leading* her specialty. Yet her professional identity remained tightly bound to engineering.

Boris suggested that Lianne expand her professional identity to include leadership. An exercise he suggested provoked an "aha" moment. When pushed to think beyond her job description, she and Boris recognized her strengths as a systems thinker: a strong capacity to see and connect the dots in complex situations—and offer logical, collaborative ideas.

"If you combine this capacity with business modeling," said Boris, "you'll see the bigger picture here at Spartan—and be able to do something about it."

"I'm ready to learn," said Lianne. "How about another mentoring session tomorrow?"

1Q

Is it time to ***Move Up?***

2Q

Is it time to ***Move Out?***

3Q

Is it time to ***Adapt Your Style?***

Business Model Basics

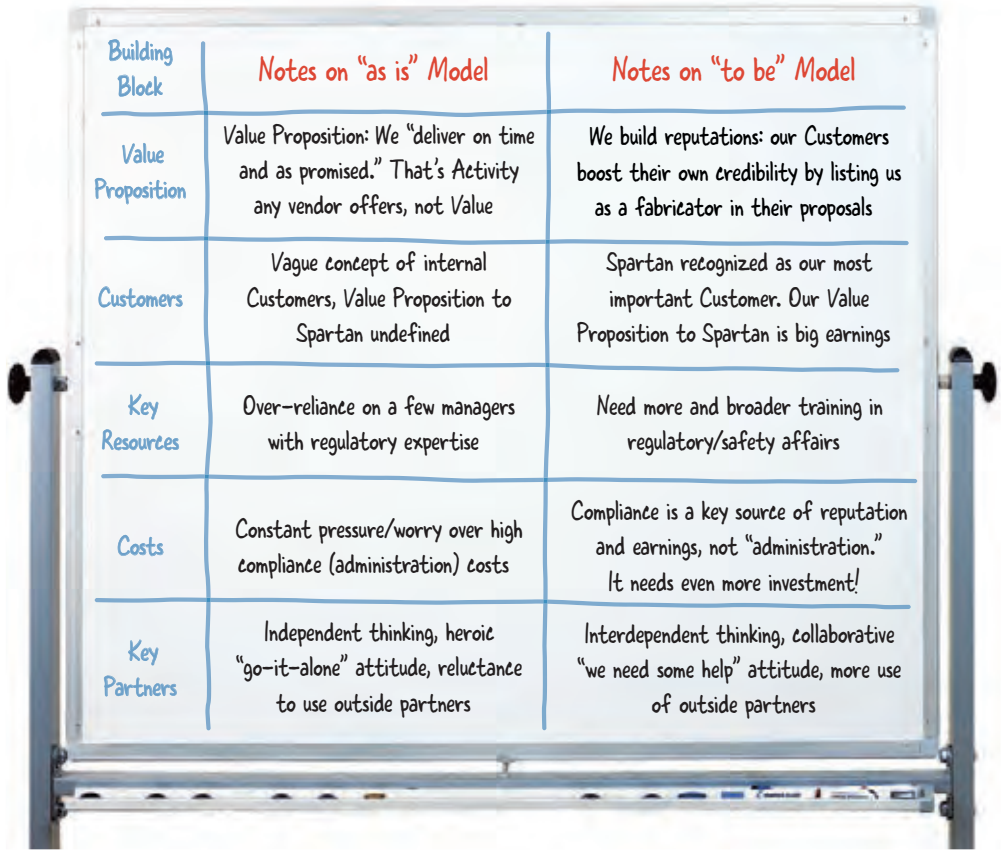
The next day, Boris demonstrated enterprise, team, and personal business model basics, then helped Lianne draw the Nuclear team model. The insights flowed as she saw how the nine Canvas elements were interrelated. "This lets us visualize how we operate as a business within a business," she said. "I'm going to ask my team to diagram our model."

Two days later found Lianne and four of her staff busy working with oversized Canvas posters in a conference room, diagramming "as is" and "to be" models of the Nuclear team. "This is great stuff!" exclaimed a senior project director, after the colleagues had spent nearly three hours diagramming and discussing their team business model. "I've worked here for eight years and managed projects worth tens of millions of dollars. But no ever explained our business model to me. Why did this take so long?"

"I know what you mean," Lianne sighed. "But insights take as long as they take. Let's list up what we've learned from analyzing our team model." She stepped to a whiteboard, grabbed some colored markers, and wrote down points as her colleagues called them out.

"I'm going to share this with upper management and open some eyes and ears!" Lianne exclaimed as the meeting disbanded. She felt more excited about work than she had in months. Determined to win support for her nuclear team's "to be" model, she immediately called Damian's secretary and scheduled a meeting.

But her meeting with Damian flopped.



Building Block	Notes on "as is" Model	Notes on "to be" Model
Value Proposition	Value Proposition: We "deliver on time and as promised." That's Activity any vendor offers, not Value	We build reputations: our Customers boost their own credibility by listing us as a fabricator in their proposals
Customers	Vague concept of internal Customers, Value Proposition to Spartan undefined	Spartan recognized as our most important Customer. Our Value Proposition to Spartan is big earnings
Key Resources	Over-reliance on a few managers with regulatory expertise	Need more and broader training in regulatory/safety affairs
Costs	Constant pressure/worry over high compliance (administration) costs	Compliance is a key source of reputation and earnings, not "administration." It needs even more investment!
Key Partners	Independent thinking, heroic "go-it-alone" attitude, reluctance to use outside partners	Interdependent thinking, collaborative "we need some help" attitude, more use of outside partners

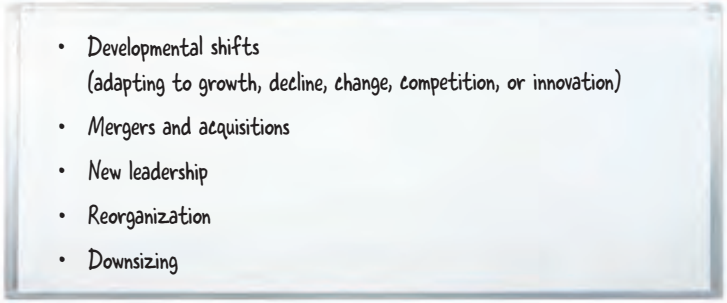
Business Model Disruptors

Lianne confessed her debacle to Boris at their next mentoring session. "I had the model refined and explained everything. But in minutes he was looking at his phone and glancing at the clock," she lamented. "Maybe I overwhelmed him with too much information and not enough context."

"Exactly, Lianne. Your intent was good and your model well described. But what do you think about the timing with Damian?"

Lianne thought for a moment. "It was all wrong. I jumped the gun. I tried to engage him before he had any background with business models. I was only talking about my team, not the relationship to his. He didn't see the need. To him and his cowboy boots, it was just another annoyance."

"Remember, you spent hours learning with me," said Boris. "Damian is like everyone else. He needs to learn business model basics first, not just see it being used by someone else." Boris paused. "Maybe it would help to consider five common business model disruptors." He walked to the whiteboard and wrote the following five phrases:



"These five events are red flags signaling that a team or enterprise needs to examine its business model," he said. "What do you notice about this list?"

Lianne thought briefly, then exclaimed, "We're dealing with two of them at once!" Boris smiled knowingly. "Reorganizations and new leadership usually happen at the same time. What have you noticed about Spartan's internal response to these events?"

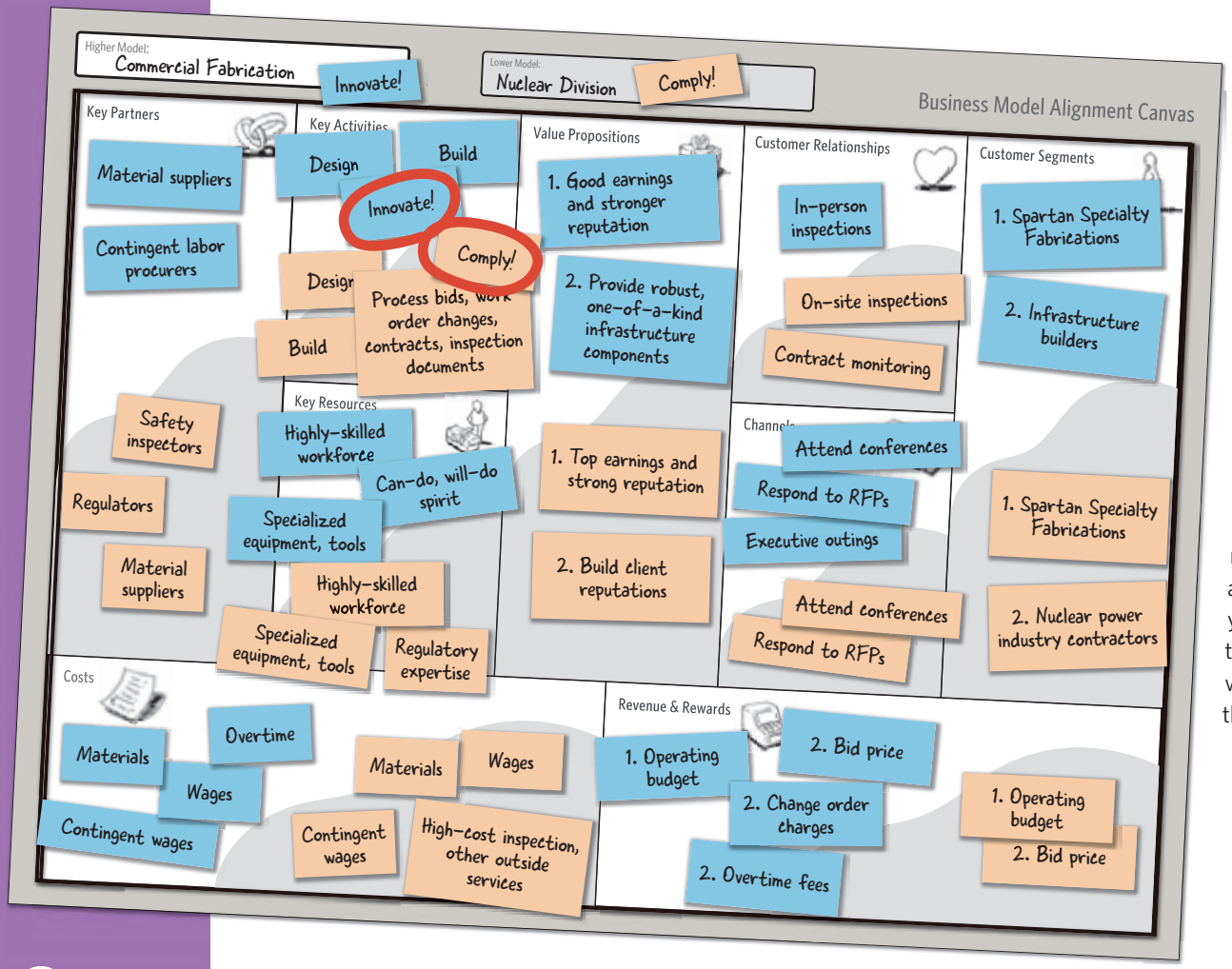
This time Lianne replied immediately. "No one talks about how a reorganization changes business models. All we got was a new organization chart." She paused. "Metal-banging culture is not introspective. No one wants to talk about what's happening internally. Maybe it's too touchy-feely."

"As my daughter would say, too *emo*," Boris countered.

"Too *girly!*" Lianne shouted. Together, mentor and mentee burst out laughing and were unable to stop for a full minute. The older man regained his composure first.

"So what does all this suggest about how to engage with Damian?" asked Boris. Lianne looked quizzical. "Here's another tool that might help," he said.

Spotting a Gap: Innovate vs. Comply



"This tool juxtaposes two business models to check for alignment—or misalignment," said Boris. He unrolled a poster-sized paper, taped it to the wall of Lianne's office, and explained Alignment Canvas basics. "Now, draw Commercial Fabrication as your higher model, and the Nuclear team as your lower model," the mentor instructed. He sat and watched as Lianne outlined the two models on the poster.

Building Block	Commercial Fabrication	Nuclear Division
Key Activities	Watchword: Innovate! Focus on designing and building from scratch	Watchword: Comply! Focus on documenting bids, contracts, change orders, inspections, building to plan
Customers	Customers value innovation, speed, and cost-cutting. They are lightly regulated	Customers value compliance, caution, and orthodoxy. They are highly regulated
Revenue	Varies widely with negotiated change order/overtime fees. Based on general estimates	Predictable and reliable revenue stream, based on careful calculations
Costs	Low outside contractor expenses; safety inspectors are already on payroll	High outside contractor expenses; quality inspectors, auditors, specialized engineering consultants are not on payroll
Key Resources	Minimal training needs. Can draw people from other Spartan divisions as needed	Strong need for training in regulatory/safety affairs. No such expertise elsewhere in Spartan

Lianne and Boris compared and contrasted the Commercial Fabrication and Nuclear team business models for a full hour and a half. Then Lianne suggested listing key differences between the two models. Boris walked briskly to the whiteboard and grabbed a black marker. Lianne made observations and Boris wrote them down.

"This is amazing," said Lianne. "And it gives me an idea how I might get Damian on board."

Making the Case with PINT

For months, Lianne had been pushing Damian for approval to hire two additional quality engineers. She requested a three-hour meeting with her boss—and she had to wait two weeks to get one. *But the wait was well worth it*, Lianne thought later.

At the session, Lianne taught Damian Canvas basics, shared her Nuclear team model, then unveiled an Alignment Canvas showing the Commercial Fabrication model juxtaposed with the Nuclear team model. Finally, she unrolled a large, handwritten document. "Boris calls this the Valuable Work Detector," she said. "I just call it the **PINT tool**."

"Well, I must say I'm impressed," Damian admitted when they were done. "I remember the Canvas from an executive MBA class I took a few years back, but thought it was just for startups. And this is my first time with the PINT tool." He looked down at his boots for a moment and hesitated before speaking.

"Listen, Lianne," Damian continued as he looked up, "I've got my hands full running Commercial Fab, overseeing Nuclear and Defense, plus doing general management. Maybe your needs haven't shown up enough on my radar. But you make a good case why Commercial Fab and Nuclear don't align. Feels sort of like a forced fit."

Lianne fought the urge to remind Damian that he had pushed for Nuclear to be under his group. But she saw her opening, and surprised herself with the words that tumbled out. "Well, Damian, let's do something about a situation neither of us likes. How about we present this Alignment Canvas together at the next executive off-site and call for action on it?"

Damian floored Lianne with his quick, positive reply.

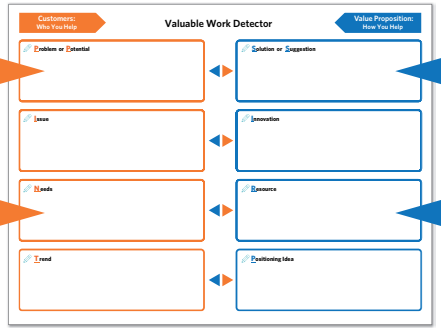
"It's a deal," he said.

Problem or Potential

Reorganizations disrupt team business models.
Yet we lacked shared definitions of our team models both before and after the reorganization.
Actions and resources are not ideally aligned.

Needs

Nuclear's recruitment and compensation needs differ from Commercial Fabrication's. For example, Nuclear needs certified quality engineers who are more highly paid than the safety inspectors used by Commercial Fabrication.



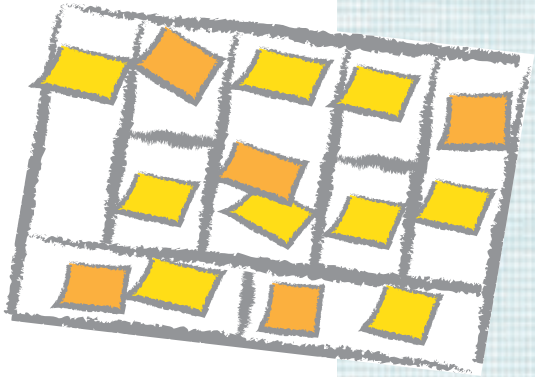
Solution or Suggestion

Collaboratively define and agree on team models everyone can understand and share.
Adjust actions and resources accordingly.

Resource

A different compensation scheme will ensure Nuclear continues to meet its earning goals for Spartan. Success depends on hiring these more expensive professionals.

The Method Acknowledged



A week later, Lianne sat in her office reviewing initial drafts of recruitment advertisements for the new quality engineers. She frowned at the orthodox job descriptions human resources had provided. Then a smile slowly spread across her face as she imagined herself using business models to explain things to promising candidates.

She sketched out a generic personal business model to characterize the new quality engineer role, and became lost in thought imagining new ways such a "role model" might be advertised. *How could we ask applicants to respond? Hmmm . . .* Suddenly she sensed the presence of another person.

Francis, Spartan's CEO, was standing quietly in her doorway, waiting to be noticed.

Lianne jumped in her chair. "Oh! Hello, Francis."

"Don't get up," the older man said. "I hear you've been stretched pretty thin and just wanted to say 'thanks' for the big effort and good results."

Lianne acknowledged his words with a flushed smile, and Francis let out a booming laugh. "And what's this I hear about the 'modeling' craze you started?' I hope this doesn't mean we all have to start getting dressed up for work!"

"Well, yes! . . . I mean no . . . I mean, we've already got some pretty snappy dressers," Lianne stammered, then laughed along with the CEO.

"Anyway, I look forward to your presentation with Damian at the off-site," Francis said. "Just talk with Samantha and let her know how much time you need." Then he was gone.

Lianne could barely contain her excitement. She fumbled for her phone and dropped it. An unintended kick sent it clattering across the floor. Finally, she picked it up and punched a speed-dial number. A moment later a familiar voice answered.

"Boris, it's me!" said Lianne. "Could we move our Friday session to tomorrow? . . . Good. And we might have to go longer than usual . . ."

Training the Explainers

"Thanks for making time today, Boris." Lianne bustled around her office, clearing papers off her desk and setting out sticky notes, a tape dispenser, and sheets of multicolored sticky dots.

"Glad to," said Boris. "This is a big opportunity. How much time do you have for your session?"

"I've got three hours! One thing I've learned from you—and Damian—is that anything less would just be gesturing at the method. No one would come away understanding how to use it." Lianne finished tidying up, sat down, and faced her mentor.

"Sounds good," said Boris. "How about previewing your session for me? Remember, you'll be training people who will explain modeling to others, including the CEO—the Chief Explaining Officer!"

Lianne settled into the chair, then gave her mentor a thorough overview, jumping up from time to time to point at a flipchart and Canvases. Here and there Boris made a few suggestions. He was clearly pleased with his mentee's knowledge and enthusiasm, especially given that this would be her first management presentation in front of the entire, all-male executive team.

"You're ready," said Boris. "And here are some reminders to pass on to your co-presenter. I don't think Damian is as savvy about teaching as you."

- Think 'touch and go'—show how business models solve problems that personally *touch* people so they'll *go* with you to a new place. Address emotions, not just intellect. "Even cowboys have feelings," Boris said with a wink.
- Avoid extended presentations to a group. Participants should spend most of the time working together in groups.
- Use third objects (Canvases, flipcharts, drawings, sticky notes, etc.) to represent complex systems. Third objects help people avoid abstract discussion and focus on concrete construction.
- Start by practicing one technique at a time. Combining multiple techniques in a single exercise is confusing.

"Thanks, Boris," said Lianne. "Wish me luck."

Breakthrough

At the off-site executive meeting a week later, Lianne opened by defining the term "business model," using the dramatic example of Haloid's invention of the plain-paper dry copier. She then delivered an overview of the Business Model Canvas, and had participants break into teams for a fun but enlightening low-pressure exercise: diagramming the Starbucks business model. Following a break, Damian facilitated team diagramming of Commercial Fabrication's business model.

Lianne introduced the Alignment Canvas and conducted a question-and-answer session. Then, as arranged beforehand, Damian gave a "narrated walking tour" of the Commercial Fabrication portion of the Alignment Canvas, explaining each building block as he placed sticky notes on the paper. Participants nodded their heads as Damian proceeded, for his group was most familiar to them. Even so, they had never seen the business so clearly described. But that clarity was outshone by what they discovered next about the relationship between the Commercial Fabrication and Nuclear Division models.

Lianne started by placing different colored notes on the lower portion of the building blocks representing her Nuclear Division, and telling the story of how her team operated. But midway through her narration, managers began frowning and exchanging quizzical looks, as if to say, "This arrangement makes no sense. Why do things seem so disjointed?"

The questions flew, and Lianne's plans for the rest of this session collapsed in the best possible way. People spontaneously stepped forward to add or remove sticky notes. A spirited discussion overtook the group. No one tracked time. After a while, Francis, the CEO, banged a spoon against a water glass until the room quieted.

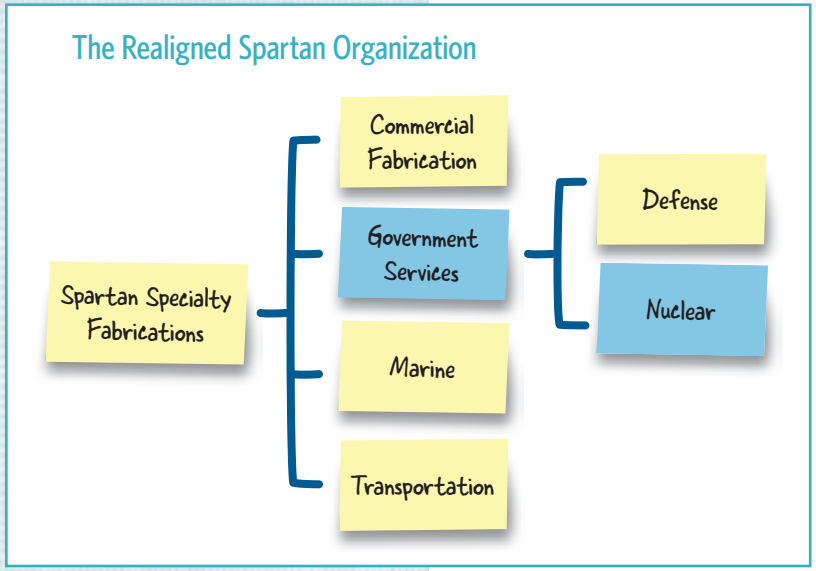
"Lianne and Damian have shown us something very important," he said. "For us, business models are not about changing strategy. We are a proven company and we are doing well." The room grew still quieter as Francis faced the two presenters. "But we need a common framework for understanding problems—a more precise way to adjust how we operate. And we need a better way to collaborate. We may have found what we need."

Lianne struggled to keep a modest look on her face. But inside she exulted like a marathon winner.

Realignment

Two months had passed since the executive retreat, and tonight found mentor and mentee together at Lianne's favorite Indian restaurant. "My treat," she had insisted. Boris munched his tandoori chicken as Lianne recounted a series of events at Spartan that had occurred with startling speed, resulting in much-needed relief for both her and Damian.

First, Spartan had created a new business unit called Government Services, reporting directly to the CEO. The new business unit included the Nuclear and Defense teams, and Lianne now served in a dual role: as director of Government Services and leader of the Nuclear team. Her recruitment and hiring needs were addressed with the same consideration given to every other unit within Spartan.



Second, Francis had taken a keen interest in Lianne's business model initiative. According to Francis, her work was "helping us go beyond our usual opinion-slinging, rambling discussions that trigger more argument than action." In particular, Francis was struck by Lianne's definition of internal Customers, and her appeal that Spartan teams avoid a "false sense of separateness that prevents collaborative action."

Finally, Lianne's relationship with Damian had improved dramatically. He and Lianne were sharing more staff, and collaborating on work to help reduce the extreme revenue swings inherent in Commercial Fabrication's operations. Damian had grown noticeably more polite and respectful to Lianne. And if Lianne was not mistaken, he seemed to have changed his taste in footwear.

"I'm so glad to hear that," Boris said, his satisfaction evident. "I guess my work here is done."

Passing it On

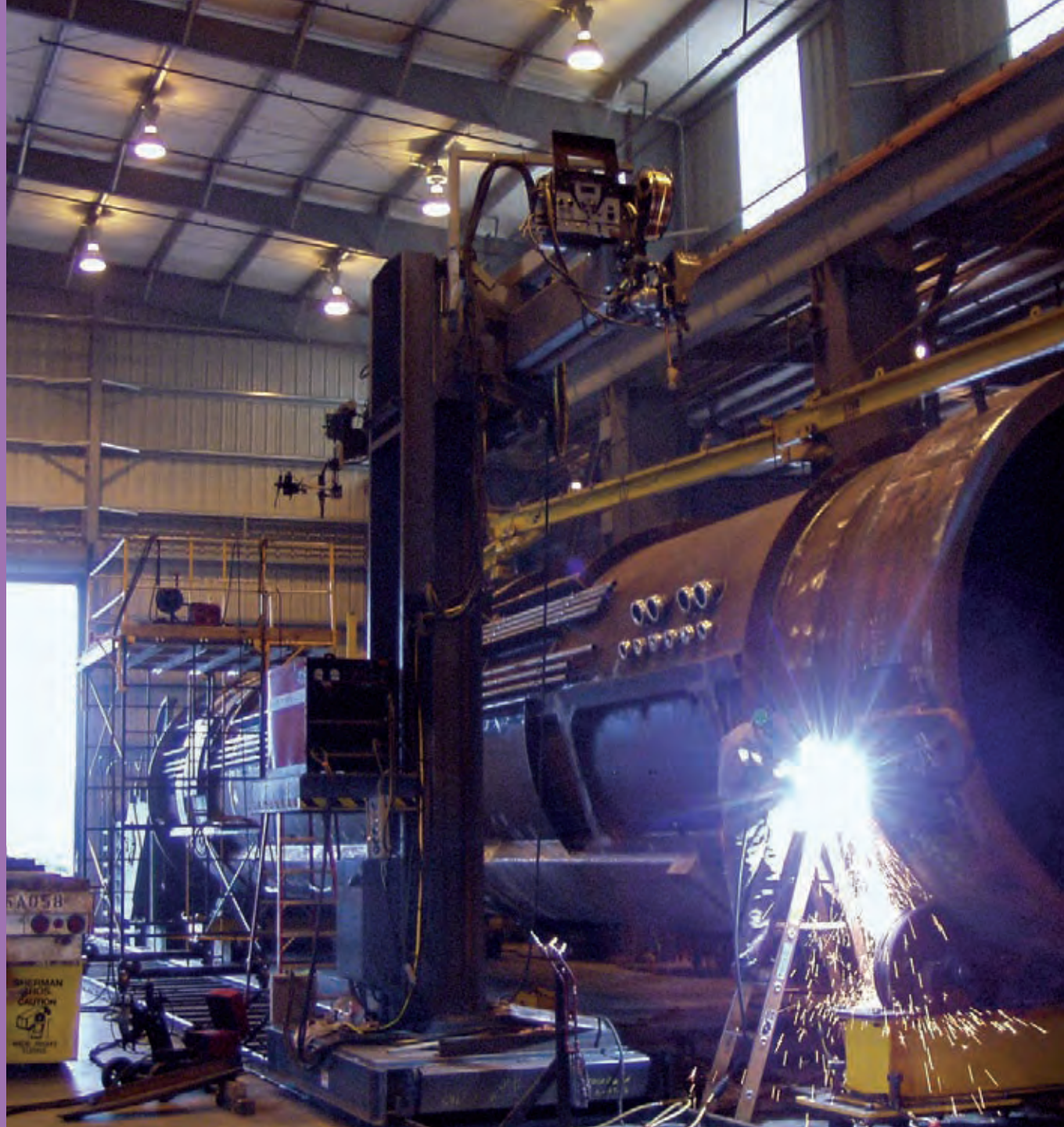
Three days later, as Lianne sat at her desk reviewing finalists for the quality engineer positions, she saw the manager of the Defense team approaching her office. He was smiling and rubbing his hands together like a man about to relish a fine meal.

"OK, I'm ready!" he said.

"For what?"

"I want you to mentor me on getting started with business modeling. I'll start from where I stand. I don't want to wait for Spartan to turn this into a company-wide thing, though I wouldn't be surprised if Francis does just that. I think we've all had our own 'aha' moments, thanks to you. You really let the genie out of the bottle."

Lianne smiled. "I'll be glad to share what worked and what didn't. But first . . ." She opened her desk drawer, rummaged around, then pulled out a business card. "Call Boris. And keep the card. Someday you may pass it on."



Make Things Better

Lianne's experience is one example of using team business models to solve operational problems. But while solving concrete problems, Lianne also started nudging Spartan's workforce toward greater engagement and alignment.

You can do the same thing in your organization. The next chapter shows you how to apply the method, drawing on everything you have learned so far. You will learn a specific process you can adapt to your own needs, illustrated by examples of how leaders in the insurance, software, and technology sectors are using business models to make things better.

Chapter 8

Application Guide

Applying team business models calls for some preparation, but it does not demand a massive, enterprise-wide initiative. This chapter will show you:

- How to prepare to implement team business models
- A step-by-step approach you can adapt to your own needs
- Examples of how three different organizations used team business models to address specific problems

Getting Ready

Before starting, learn from those who have gone before. Here are some hard-won tips based on the successes (and blunders!) experienced by dozens of leaders who have used the methods in organizations ranging from tiny nonprofits to global conglomerates.

Clarify Your Purpose

Be clear about your purpose. Do you want to use business models mainly to solve problems or address opportunities? Or do you want to use business models to start distributing leadership and encouraging self-direction among team members? The first purpose suggests an intervention. The second implies ongoing use and fundamental change. Business modeling is useful for both, and the two often overlap.

Draw Your Own Models First

If you have not yet done so, draw your own personal business model.[1] This will make you familiar with the method and will be tremendously helpful in assessing your current role: are you doing the work you want to at this point in your life? How would you characterize your commitment to your current team and organization? Are you ready to "walk the talk" as the leader of a business model implementation? These are crucial questions to ask and answer. Then, draw your organization and team models. Are you personally aligned with both? Avoid the temptation to skip this step! You might think, "I get it, and I know what it would tell me," and then not actually do it. But doing it is interesting and instructive—even fun.

Define a Goal, Get Buy-In

Start with the end in mind, as Stephen Covey recommends,[2] and ensure team members agree on the goal. Without participant buy-in, even minor change initiatives are likely to fail. If your aim is to address a specific problem or opportunity, make sure team members agree it is a challenge worth addressing. If you lead a well-functioning team, your goal may simply be to experiment with the method as a new way to train or orient team members, for example. If so, be prepared to accept your experiment's results and take appropriate action.

Find a Thought Partner

Do not work alone! Find a thought partner to help you design and implement. You will need an empathetic colleague, teammate, human resource

professional, coach, or consultant to provide objectivity and challenge your thinking. Your thought partner may also implement or train, freeing you to wholly engage in the process as a participant rather than as someone standing apart from your team. However you proceed, having a supportive ally will energize you.

Embrace the "Risk"

It may seem risky for leaders to directly address team and individual purpose with employees. Some managers fear the process will prompt people to leave the organization. Others feel they might "lose control." By this they often mean, *How can I be sure my employees will reach the conclusions I want them to reach?* But let us be honest. *All jobs are temporary.* Employees will leave when they want to leave. If your team or enterprise business model is flawed, why not discover that sooner rather than later? Think of it another way: is it not riskier to *avoid* facing these fundamental issues?

Practice Over Program

As with most new ideas, some colleagues will wait and watch to see if team business modeling is merely a management fad (the latest "program"). Their skepticism is well justified: up to 70 percent of all organizational change initiatives fail, according to one prominent leadership consultant.[3] Employee engagement researcher Paul Marciano says people view programs as something done for a limited time rather than as templates for permanent behavior change.[4]

Stay Flexible

Stay flexible. Workplaces are too diverse for one type of implementation to be effective everywhere. Remember that tools are simply means for facilitating more potent, meaningful interactions between people. Following Canvas guidelines, for example, is helpful (and sometimes essential to avoid getting bogged down). But do not let guidelines get in the way of your bigger goals. If something is not working, admit it to everyone, and try something else. If you have team members who learn to use modeling very quickly, slow down the learning so others do not fall behind in their understanding. Have fast learners coach others and make yourself especially available during the initial learning. One of the extra benefits of learning business modeling together is that it builds team cohesion, joint decision making, and leadership skills.

Chapter 9

New Ways to Work

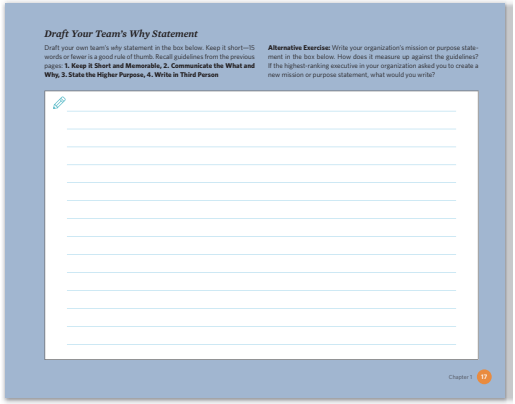
1. Define Your Purpose in Modeling

It makes good sense to define the purpose of your business modeling initiative before getting started. So far the book has presented two opportunities to reflect on organizational and team purpose. If you have not yet done so, return to Chapter 1 (page 17) and complete the **Draft Your Team's *Why* Statement.** Then, revisit Chapter 6 (page 175) and try the **Define the *Why*** exercise.

The two exercises are similar. If you complete both—or complete the same exercise on more than one occasion—you may find that your responses differ. This is perfectly normal. Welcome to the world of business modeling! Forget perfection. Instead, strive for a simple, workable *why* definition that helps you and your colleagues.

Now, given your *why* definition, decide on the purpose of your business modeling initiative. Do you need to solve problems? Capitalize on opportunities? Distribute leadership? Encourage self-direction among team members?

Once you feel you have reasonably defined the purpose of your business modeling initiative, you may want to "test" the viability of different approaches to your work. This is where Pre-Briefing can help.

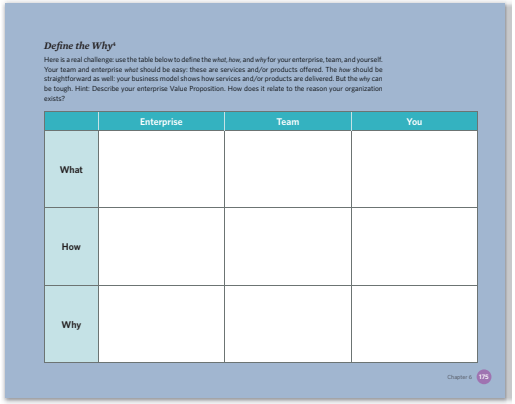


Draft Your Team's Why Statement

Draft your own team's *why* statement in the box below. Keep it short—15 words or fewer is a good rule of thumb. Recall guidelines from the previous pages: **1. Keep it Short and Memorable, 2. Communicate the What and Why, 3. State the Higher Purpose, 4. Write in Third Person**

Alternative Exercise: Write your organization's mission or purpose statement in the box below. How does it measure up against the guidelines? If the highest-ranking executive in your organization asked you to create a new mission or purpose statement, what would you write?

Chapter 1 17



***Define the Why*[4]**

Here is a real challenge: use the table below to define the *what, how,* and *why* for your enterprise, team, and yourself. Your team and enterprise *what* should be easy: these are services and/or products offered. The *how* should be straightforward as well: your business model shows how services and/or products are delivered. But the *why* can be tough. Hint: Describe your enterprise Value Proposition. How does it relate to the reason your organization exists?

	Enterprise	Team	You
What			
How			
Why			

Chapter 6 175

Pre-Briefing

Everyone understands *debriefing* as a good way to learn from hindsight. After completing a piece of work, a team reviews mistakes made, assumptions proven faulty, and so forth, then brainstorms ways similar problems might be prevented next time.

But surely things would have gone better if the team had anticipated those mistakes *before* getting started. That is the idea behind *pre-briefing*, which takes place *before* a project starts. It asks you to imagine the risks, unforeseen events, and missing or careless actions that might combine to cause failure or underperformance.

Conducting a pre-briefing session is simple, and is best done with a thought partner (or the team about to undertake the work). Getting thoughts out of your head and onto paper is an important first step. But sharing your thinking aloud with an empathetic listener(s) will advance your project much farther compared to working solo. So if you have been working on your own, now is the perfect time for you to engage a thought partner (more on this soon).

To start your pre-briefing, simply ask and discuss the question, *What might go wrong*? Voice and list concerns, then rank them in order of risk or likelihood. Finally, determine potential counter-measures. What must go right? Make sure to take and retain good notes!

If you conduct your pre-briefing with a team, you might want to start by soliciting written rather than verbal responses. This gathers more perspectives and helps keep the subsequent discussion from being dominated by the first or most confident speakers. Encourage experience-based comments over formal risk analysis. You could then list the comments, prioritize them, and decide on preventative actions that become part of the work. End on a positive note about the opportunities ahead (and save notes on threats and preventive actions).

A Note on *Debriefings*

Debriefings are meant to foster continuous improvement. But they are often skipped: sometimes because of pressure to move on, and sometimes because of reluctance to discuss unresolved conflicts that arose during the course of the work. Here is a reality check for leaders: Are you letting relationships suffer in service to the expediency of completing work? If so, you are missing a tremendous learning opportunity—and restraining personal growth for your team and yourself. Once you start doing *pre*-briefings, you will have a new third object tool to use for *de*briefings. At your next debriefing, share your *pre*-briefing disaster scenarios or "what could go wrong" lists, and see which threats were successfully anticipated or avoided. Celebrate your successes!

Creator Biographies

Dr. Timothy Clark, Author

Tim is a NEXT-certified entrepreneurship trainer, educator, and author who leads the global personal business model movement at BusinessModelYou.com. After selling his six-year-old startup to a NASDAQ-listed entity in a multi-million-dollar transaction, he completed doctoral research in international business model portability and authored or edited five books on entrepreneurship, business models, and personal development, including the international bestsellers *Business Model You* and *Business Model Generation,* which together have sold more than one million copies in 30 languages.

Previously Tim served as a consultant and researcher for clients such as Amazon.com, Bertelsmann Financial Services, Intel, and PeopleSoft. For six years he authored the monthly Japan Entrepreneur Report and Japan Internet Report newsletters, and wrote the first-ever syndicated English-language research reports covering Japan's Web and Internet-enabled mobile telephone sectors. A Stanford University graduate, he holds master's and doctorate degrees in business administration and has served as a professor at the University of Tsukuba and as Senior Fellow for Tokyo-based venture-capital firm Sunbridge.

Bruce Blackstone Hazen, M.S., Co-Author

Bruce is a career and management coach who has guided leaders and their followers to personally tailored answers to The Three Career Questions for over 18 years. As a speaker, trainer, and consultant, his mission is clear: reduce workplace suffering, increase career satisfaction, give clients a bigger theory of the game, and prevent them from spending their careers finding "one-job-in-a-row." He earned undergraduate and master's degrees in Industrial and Labor Relations and Clinical Psychology from Cornell University and San Jose State University, respectively, and for 25 years served in both human resource and line management positions in the technology, healthcare, and professional service sectors.

Bruce is the President of Three Questions Consulting and the author of *Answering The Three Career Questions: Your Lifetime Career Management System.* He co-authored the career coaching chapter in *The Complete Handbook of Coaching* and was a contributing co-author to *Business Model You.*

Keiko Onodera, Designer

A Tokyo native, Keiko graduated from the Kuwsawa Design School. While a student, she worked at design studio and created the official Takigawa Beauty College logo, which is still in use today. Following graduation, she was hired as a packaging designer by foodmaker Yukijirushi's R&D center, the largest such research group in Japan, where she was granted patents for her innovative designs. Next, she joined a team of more than 100 creatives at global cosmetics giant Shiseido, where she designed promotional products and packaging.

Keiko moved to the United States in 1991 and worked with Honolulu-based visual design firm UCI, focusing on graphics and packaging, while serving as a freelance graphic designer for magazine advertisements and other publications. She then co-founded an online market research and customer acquisition services consultancy, where she designed Japanese language Web sites and online marketing programs for clients such as Amazon .com, JCPenney, and Neiman Marcus. Today she works as an independent designer.

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